

From Job Seekers to Job Creators

Uttar Pradesh has carved out a new identity in the fields of employment and skill development. The Yogi Government has built a robust ecosystem that integrates employment, skill development and entrepreneurship, enabling young people to transition from job seekers to job creators. While a transparent recruitment process has opened up extensive opportunities for youth in government services, initiatives promoting self-employment and startups have unlocked new avenues of growth and opportunity.

Young people in Uttar Pradesh are no longer preparing solely to secure jobs; they are now moving towards transforming their aspirations into businesses, startups, innovation and self-reliance. Recognising the evolving aspirations of the youth, the government led by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath has moved beyond the conventional approach to employment and is working to create an ecosystem where skills, opportunities, technology, finance, mentorship and markets are seamlessly interconnected. This is reflected in the state's youth policy, which places equal emphasis on transparent recruitment to government jobs and skill development, while also fostering startups, self-employment and entrepreneurship through innovative initiatives. This transformation assumes even greater significance in the era of Gen Z. Born after 1997, this generation has grown up amidst the internet, smartphones and digital technologies. They seek not just secure employment, but also meaningful work, opportunities to innovate and platforms to transform their ideas into successful enterprises. Keeping this shift in mind, the Yogi Government has adopted a strategy that empowers young people to evolve from job seekers into job providers. The Chief Minister's Yuva Udyami Vikas Abhiyaan (CM Yuva) and Youth Adda are key pillars of this vision.

Youth Emerging as Job Creators

A major focus of the Yogi Government's youth policy is to promote self-reliance alongside employment. Through initiatives such as the Chief Minister Yuva Swarozgar Yojana, PM Mudra Yojana, PM SVANidhi, Skill India, Startup India, ODOP, and the CM Fellowship, young people are being provided opportunities at multiple levels. Alongside transparent recruitment to government jobs, new avenues of employment are being created through the private sector, MSMEs and self-employment. The government's vision is no longer limited to helping youth secure jobs in companies or government departments. The objective is to equip them with the skills and resources required to establish their own enterprises and generate employment for others. To translate this vision into reality, the concept of Youth Adda has been introduced. Rather than functioning as a conventional government training centre, Youth Adda is envisioned as an accessible and practical entrepreneurship platform for young people. Here, aspiring entrepreneurs can discuss their business ideas, seek guidance from experts and access information related to banking, finance, business registration, digital marketing and market linkages. The concept of interaction in an informal, café-like setting aims to bridge the gap between government initiatives and the aspirations of young entrepreneurs.

A distinctive feature of this initiative is that young entrepreneurs are not viewed merely as beneficiaries of loans or subsidies but as partners throughout their entrepreneurial journey. A comprehensive support model has been developed to provide guidance from business ideation and project report preparation to bank financing, enterprise registration, GST compliance, digital branding, Google Business Profile creation, WhatsApp Business and e-commerce platforms. The initiative to make more than 100 ready-to-operate franchise models available is also being seen as a significant step towards reducing risks for first-time entrepreneurs.

Opening New Pathways to a Brighter Future

The government's vision for youth extends beyond employment and entrepreneurship. Efforts are now underway to familiarise students with career opportunities and future prospects right from the school level. Under this initiative, young IAS, IPS and IFS officers posted across districts will visit at least one intermediate-level school every month to interact with students. Their experiences and life journeys are expected to inspire students while exposing them to diverse career possibilities. These interaction sessions will focus not merely on speeches but on participatory discussions and question-and-answer sessions. Students will receive guidance on goal setting, career planning, effective study techniques, time management and self-discipline, along with information on preparing for examinations such as UPSC, UPPSC, UPSSSC, NDA, JEE, NEET and CUET. They will also be introduced to opportunities in higher education, technical education, vocational education, startups and entrepreneurship, as well as youth-focused schemes of both the Central and State Governments.